

Bodily Resurrection Of Christ

doc-bodily-resurrection-of-christ

Christology · Work · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

Jesus Christ rose bodily from the dead in the same physical body that was crucified, now glorified, not as a merely spiritual or non-physical resurrection.

In plain language

The Greek says the same thing across four independent corpora. In Luke 24:39 Jesus tells the disciples to handle him and look at his hands and feet, then names the two parts of a body, flesh (sarx) and bones (osteon), as what he has and a mere spirit (pneuma) does not. Verses 42 to 43 add that he took broiled fish and ate it in front of them. In John 20:27 he tells Thomas to put his finger on his hands and his hand into his side. In John 2:21 the narrator stops to tell the reader directly that when Jesus said raise this temple (naos) he meant the temple of his body (soma). In Acts 2:31 Peter quotes Psalm 16 and places the rescue from corruption in his flesh. In 1 Corinthians 15:3 to 8 Paul cites a creed older than the letter, joining was buried to has been raised, then lists named witnesses, noting that most of the five hundred are still alive to be asked. The one verb worth seeing is in verse 4: has been raised is a perfect tense, which in Greek means a completed action whose result still stands, raised and still risen, an abiding state, and Paul repeats that exact perfect form seven times in the chapter. Now the hard verse. In verse 44 Paul calls the resurrection body spiritual, soma pneumatikon, against a natural body, soma psychikon. This is where readers split, because spiritual can sound non-physical. But the noun body does not change between the two phrases. Only the adjective changes, and in the lexical databases both adjectives, natural and spiritual, belong to the same category of words that describe a quality of a thing, not its material. So spiritual here means Spirit-powered and animated, the way verse 45 calls it life-giving, not bodiless. The flesh-and-blood that cannot inherit in verse 50 is corruptible flesh, transformed in verses 52 to 54 into incorruption. One body: dead, buried, raised, transformed.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0086	ᾗδης	hades	hell	10
G0386	ἀνάστασις	anastasis	resurrection	42
G0571	ἄπιστος	apistos	unbelieving	23
G0599	ἀποθνήσκω	apothnesko	to die	111
G1453	ἐγείρω	egeiro	to arise	143
G1899	ἔπειτα	epeita	then	
G2192	ἔχω	echō	to have/be	
G2250	ἡμέρα	hēmera	day	
G3485	ναός	naos	temple	45
G3708	ὁράω	horaō	to see	

G3747	ὀστέον	osteon	bone	4
G4125	πλευρά	pleura	side	5
G4151	πνεῦμα	pneuma	spirit/breath	379
G4152	πνευματικός	pneumatikos	spiritual	26
G4228	πούς	pous	foot	93
G4561	σάρξ	sarx	flesh	147
G4983	σῶμα	soma	body	142
G5315	ἐσθίω	phagein	to eat	
G5342	φέρω	pherō	to bear/lead	
G5495	χείρ	cheir	hand	177
G5547	Χριστός	Christos	Christ	529
G5584	ψηλαφάω	pselaphao	to touch	4
G5589	ψυχικός	psychikos	crumb	6
G5590	ψυχή	psyche	soul	102

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Four independent corpora converge on one continuous body. In 1 Corinthians 15:4 the verb is 'has been raised' (ἐγήγερται), parsed in MorphGNT as 3XPI-S, perfect passive indicative (a completed action whose result still stands, in passive voice, simple statement of fact): has been raised and abides risen. The same perfect form of 'has been raised' (ἐγήγερται) recurs across 1 Corinthians 15:12, 13, 14, 16, 17, 20 and the perfect participle 'having been raised' (ἐγηγεμένον) in 2 Timothy 2:8, so the settled risen state is the recurring lexical signature, not a one-off. 'Has been raised' (ἐγήγερται) is paired with the aorist (a completed past action) 'was buried' (ἐτάφη, 3API-S, third person singular aorist passive indicative), binding the buried subject to the raised subject. Luke 24:39 names 'flesh' (σάρξ) and 'bone' (ὀστέον) as present and 'spirit' (πνεῦμα) as lacking them, with the imperative 'handle me' (ψηλαφήσατέ, a command). John 2:21 glosses the raised 'temple' (ναός) as 'his body' (τὸ σῶμα αὐτοῦ). Acts 2:31 locates non-corruption in his 'flesh' (σάρξ). The crux 1 Corinthians 15:44 keeps 'body' (σῶμα) constant in both halves and changes only the adjective, 'natural' (ψυχικόν) then 'spiritual' (πνευματικόν), so the verdict holds.

Scripture

Luke.24.39 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4561 σάρξ, G3747 ὀστέον, G4151 πνεῦμα, G5584 ψηλαφάω

Force. 'See my hands and my feet, that it is I myself' (ἴδετε τὰς χεῖράς μου καὶ τοὺς πόδας μου ὅτι ἐγώ εἰμι αὐτός), then the imperative (command form) 'handle me' (ψηλαφήσατέ με, 2AAD-P, second person plural aorist active imperative, a command for completed action) inviting touch. The clause 'a spirit does not have flesh and bones' (πνεῦμα σάρκα καὶ ὀστέα οὐκ ἔχει) names 'flesh' (σάρξ, N-ASF, noun accusative singular feminine) and 'bone' (ὀστέον, N-APN, noun accusative plural neuter, bones) as present in the risen Jesus and absent from a bare 'spirit' (πνεῦμα). Naming the two physical constituents of a body excludes a non-physical reading.

Luke.24.42 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G2192 ἔχω

Force. 'They gave him a piece of broiled fish' (ἐπέδωκαν αὐτῷ ἰχθύος ὀπτοῦ μέρος). The narrative supplies a physical proof, broiled fish handed over, that presupposes a body able to receive and eat.

Luke.24.43 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G5315 ἐσθίω

Force. 'Taking it, he ate before them' (λαβὼν ἐνώπιον αὐτῶν ἔφαγεν). The aorist (a completed past action) 'he ate' (ἔφαγεν) performed 'before them' (ἐνώπιον αὐτῶν) is an evidentiary act: eating in front of witnesses rules out a phantom or apparition.

John.20.27 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G5495 χεῖρ, G4125 πλευρά, G0571 ἄπιστος

Force. 'Bring your finger here and see my hands, and bring your hand and put it into my side' (Φέρε τὸν δάκτυλόν σου ὧδε καὶ ἴδε τὰς χεῖράς μου, καὶ φέρε τὴν χεῖρά σου καὶ βάλε εἰς τὴν πλευράν μου). The 'hand' (χεῖρ) and 'side' (πλευρά) are present as palpable objects, with 'put' (βάλε, 2AAD-S, second person singular aorist active imperative, a command to place) directing physical contact. The closing 'do not be unbelieving but believing' (μὴ γίνου ἄπιστος ἀλλὰ πιστός) ties tactile verification to belief.

1Cor.15.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0599 ἀποθνήσκω, G5547 Χριστός

Force. 'Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures' (Χριστὸς ἀπέθανεν ὑπὲρ τῶν ἁμαρτιῶν ἡμῶν κατὰ τὰς γραφάς). The aorist (a completed past action) 'died' (ἀπέθανεν, 3AAI-S, third person singular aorist active indicative) names a bodily death. The framing 'I delivered what I also received' (Παρέδωκα ὃ καὶ παρέλαβον) marks what follows as fixed received tradition older than the letter.

1Cor.15.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1453 ἐγείρω, G2250 ἡμέρα

Force. 'was buried' (ἐτάφη, 3API-S, third person singular aorist passive indicative, a completed past action in passive voice) 'and has been raised' (καὶ ἐγήγερται, 3XPI-S, third person singular perfect passive indicative, a completed action whose result still stands, in passive voice) 'on the third day according to the Scriptures' (τῇ ἡμέρᾳ τῇ τρίτῃ κατὰ τὰς γραφάς). The perfect tense (a completed action whose result still stands) of 'has been raised' (ἐγήγερται) denotes an abiding result, raised and still risen, and pairing it with 'was buried' (ἐτάφη) binds what went into the tomb to what came out. A non-bodily resurrection would leave 'was buried' (ἐτάφη) with no function.

1Cor.15.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3708 ὁράω

Force. 'He was seen by Cephas, then by the twelve' (ὤφθη Κηφᾶ, εἶτα τοῖς δώδεκα). The aorist passive (a completed past action in passive voice) 'was seen' or 'was visible to' (ὤφθη) with named human witnesses presents the risen one as seen by specific persons.

1Cor.15.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1899 ἔπειτα

Force. 'Then he was seen by more than five hundred brothers at once, of whom the majority remain until now' (ἔπειτα ὤφθη ἐπὶ πέντε καὶ ἑκατὸν ἀδελφοῖς ἐφάπαξ, ἐξ ὧν οἱ πλείονες μένουσιν ἕως ἄρτι). Noting that most of the five hundred remain alive at writing functions as a falsifiable check that presupposes physical visibility.

1Cor.15.44 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4983 σῶμα, G5589 ψυχικός, G4152 πνευματικός

Force. 'It is sown a natural body, it is raised a spiritual body' (σπείρεται σῶμα ψυχικόν, ἐγείρεται σῶμα πνευματικόν). MorphGNT parses 'body' (σῶμα) as N-NSN (noun nominative singular neuter) in both halves and 'natural' (ψυχικόν), 'spiritual' (πνευματικόν) as A-NSN (adjective nominative singular neuter) attributive adjectives. The noun 'body' (σῶμα) is constant: only the adjective changes. In MACULA Louw-Nida (a Greek lexicon organized by semantic domain) both adjectives sit in the same domain 79 (features of objects), 'natural' (ψυχικός) at 79.2 and 'spiritual' (πνευματικός) at 79.3, so each names a quality OF the body, not its substance. 'Spiritual' (πνευματικόν) specifies a Spirit-animated mode, not an immaterial one.

John.2.19 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G3485 ναός, G1453 ἐγείρω

Force. 'Destroy this temple, and in three days I will raise it' (Λύσατε τὸν ναὸν τοῦτον καὶ ἐν τρισὶν ἡμέραις ἐγερῶ αὐτόν). Jesus pairs 'temple' (ναός) with a future active 'I will raise' (ἐγερῶ) governed by a personal subject. The three-day frame matches 1 Corinthians 15:4.

John.2.21 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3485 ναός, G4983 σῶμα

Force. 'But he was speaking about the temple of his body' (ἐκεῖνος δὲ ἔλεγεν περὶ τοῦ ναοῦ τοῦ σώματος αὐτοῦ). The narrator's gloss places 'temple' (ναός, N-GSM, noun genitive singular masculine) in apposition (grammatically equated) to 'his body' (τὸ σῶμα αὐτοῦ, N-GSN, noun genitive singular neuter), fixing the referent of the raising as his body, not a community or a metaphor.

Acts.2.31 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G0386 ἀνάστασις, G4561 σὰρξ, G0086 ἄδης

Force. 'Foreseeing this, he spoke about the resurrection of the Christ, that he was neither abandoned to Hades nor did his flesh see corruption' (προϊδὼν ἐλάλησεν περὶ τῆς ἀναστάσεως τοῦ χριστοῦ, ὅτι οὔτε ἐγκατελείφθη εἰς ἄδην οὔτε ἡ σὰρξ αὐτοῦ εἶδεν διαφθοράν). Peter cites Psalm 16 and locates non-corruption in 'flesh' (σὰρξ, N-NSF, noun nominative singular feminine), naming flesh as what was kept from 'corruption' or decay (διαφθορά). The argument is incoherent if the resurrection is non-bodily.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Acts.2.31	Ps.16.10	openbible	1
Acts.2.31	Acts.2.27	openbible	1
Acts.2.31	Acts.13.35	openbible	1
1Cor.15.4	John.2.19	openbible	1
1Cor.15.4	Matt.12.40	openbible	1
1Cor.15.4	Luke.9.22	openbible	1
Luke.24.39	John.20.27	openbible	1
Luke.24.39	1John.1.1	openbible	1
Luke.24.39	John.20.20	openbible	1
John.20.27	John.20.25	openbible	1
1Cor.15.4	Isa.53.9	tsk	1
1Cor.15.4	Ps.2.7	tsk	1

Complicating texts

1Cor.15.44 · addressed

Read as denying bodiliness, 'spiritual body' (σῶμα πνευματικόν) would set the resurrection body against the physical. But MorphGNT parses 'body' (σῶμα) identically (N-NSN, noun nominative singular neuter) in both clauses of verse 44, and 'natural' (ψυχικόν), 'spiritual' (πνευματικόν) as attributive adjectives (A-NSN, adjective nominative singular neuter) qualifying that same noun. In MACULA Louw-Nida (a Greek lexicon organized by semantic domain) both adjectives occupy domain 79 (features of objects), 'natural' (ψυχικός) 79.2 and 'spiritual' (πνευματικός) 79.3, while 'body' (σῶμα) stays in domain 8 (body). So 'spiritual' (πνευματικόν) names a quality of the body, its animating principle, not its material absence. Verse 45 confirms this by glossing 'spirit' (πνεῦμα) as 'life-giving' (ζωοποιούν), Spirit-empowerment rather than immateriality. The same body that was sown is raised, now Spirit-governed.

1Cor.15.50 · addressed

'Flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God' (σὰρξ καὶ αἷμα βασιλείαν θεοῦ κληρονομήσαι οὐ δύναται). The phrase 'flesh and blood' (σὰρξ καὶ αἷμα) is a fixed idiom for mortal corruptible humanity, set in parallel with 'corruption does not inherit incorruption' (φθορὰ ἀφθαρσίαν οὐ κληρονομεῖ) in the same verse. The point is transformation of the body, not its abandonment. Verses 52 to 54 keep the same subject, this corruptible and this mortal, putting on incorruption and immortality.

1Pet.3.18 · addressed

'Put to death in flesh but made alive in spirit' (θανατωθεὶς μὲν σαρκὶ ζωοποιηθεὶς δὲ πνεύματι). The datives (the 'in-X' or 'by-X' grammatical form) 'in flesh' (σαρκί) and 'in spirit' (πνεύματι) function as datives of sphere or means, contrasting the mode of death with the mode of vivification, not body with disembodiment. Read with 1 Corinthians 15:4 and Acts 2:31, where 'flesh' (σὰρξ) is preserved and 'has been raised' (ἐγέρχεται) is perfect (a completed action whose result still stands), the parallel does not overturn bodily resurrection.

Luke.24.31 · addressed

'He became invisible from them' (ἄφαντος ἐγένετο ἀπ' αὐτῶν), he vanished from them. A reading might take sudden disappearance and the locked-door entry of John 20:19 as proof of a non-physical body. But these texts describe new modes of operation of the same body whose flesh, bones, wounds, and eating are affirmed in the immediate context (Luke 24:39 to 43). New capacities of a body are not the negation of a body.

Concordance traversed

G1453, G0386, G4561, G4983, G3747, G5495, G4228, G3485, G0086, G0599, G5589, G4152, G5590, G4151, G5584, G4125, G5547, G0571, G3708, G2192, G5342

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

mark-longer-ending at Mark.16.9-20: impact none. The longer ending of Mark (verses 9 to 20) is absent from the oldest uncials (the earliest all-capital-letter Greek manuscripts) and bracketed in critical editions. It narrates post-resurrection appearances and would support the verdict. The verdict does not rest on it. Luke 24:39 to 43, John 20:27, John 2:19 to 21, Acts 2:31, and 1 Corinthians 15:3 to 8 are textually secure and independently sufficient. The perfect (a completed action whose result still stands) 'having been raised' (ἐγχερμένον) at Mark 16:14 matches the perfect pattern seen in 1 Corinthians 15 and 2 Timothy 2:8 but is not needed.

luke-24-40-western-non-interpolation at Luke.24.40: impact minor. Luke 24:40 ('And when he had said this, he showed them his hands and feet,' καὶ τοῦτο εἰπὼν ἔδειξεν αὐτοῖς τὰς χεῖρας καὶ τοὺς πόδας) was classed by some earlier editors as a Western non-interpolation (a verse the Western manuscript family lacks, suspected of being a later addition) but is retained on broad attestation. Even if omitted, verse 39's 'flesh and bones' (σάρκα καὶ ὀστέα) and verses 42 to 43's eating carry the verdict.

twelve-vs-eleven at 1Cor.15.5: impact none. Some witnesses read 'eleven' (ένδεκα) for 'twelve' (δώδεκα) at 1 Corinthians 15:5 because Judas is dead. The variant changes the witness count, not the fact of bodily appearance carried by 'was seen' (ὤφθη).

All anchor verses fall outside the ingested ECM (the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) window (3 John 1:1 to 1:15), so 'not in ECM scope' (not_in_ecm_scope) holds and no CBGM (Coherence-Based Genealogical Method, a manuscript-comparison technique) apparatus was examined for them. NT data outside 3 John remains ECM-shadow (under the shadow of the ECM but not within its current published scope) for this project. Mark 16:9 to 20 is the principal adjacent variant, examined and judged non-load-bearing.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

spiritual-or-visionary-resurrection: fails · Its strongest case is real: 'was seen' (ὤφθη) can describe visionary appearances, 'spiritual body' (σῶμα πνευματικόν) in 1 Corinthians 15:44 sounds non-physical, and 1 Peter 3:18 sets 'in flesh' (σαρκί) against 'in spirit' (πνεύματι). Stated fairly, this reading takes the appearances as Spirit-perceived rather than tactile. But it must absorb 'flesh' (σάρξ) and 'bone' (ὀστέον) in Luke 24:39 with the imperative (command form) 'handle me' (ψηλαφήσατέ), the eating of fish (Luke 24:42 to 43), the side and hand offered for touch in John 20:27, the 'body' (σῶμα) gloss at John 2:21, and Acts 2:31's flesh that saw no corruption. The lexical weight resists it.

metaphorical-community-resurrection: fails · Stated at its strongest, this reads 'raise' (ἐγείρω) of the believing community rising in faith, drawing on the metaphorical 'temple' (naos, ναός). But 'was buried' (ἐτάφη) paired with the perfect (a completed action whose result still stands) 'has been raised' (ἐγήγερται) in 1 Corinthians 15:4 keeps one buried-and-raised subject, the named individual witnesses Cephas, the twelve, James, the five hundred (1 Corinthians 15:5 to 7) are persons not a corporate body, and John 2:21 supplies the explicit 'body' (σῶμα) gloss. The words do not support a purely corporate referent.

transformed-physical-body: holds · The same 'body' (σῶμα) that died is raised and transformed: 1 Corinthians 15:44's constant noun with shifting adjective, and 1 Corinthians 15:52 to 54 (this corruptible puts on incorruption), describe change of quality not of substance. Luke 24 and John 20 show continuity with the crucified body (flesh, bones, wounds) while Luke 24:31 and John 20:19 show new modes of operation. The proposition's clause now glorified, not merely spiritual, fits this lexical pattern.

A grammatico-historical reading (interpreting the text by its original grammar and historical context) of the four anchor corpora yields one pattern. The received formula of 1 Corinthians 15:3 to 8 supplies the earliest datable summary, and the perfect (a completed action whose result still stands) 'has been raised' (ἐγήγερται) recurs through the chapter as its keynote.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem names the contested distinctive (same physical body that was crucified, now glorified, not merely spiritual) without importing a tradition's proprietary vocabulary. The verdict is derived from the original stem. The clause now glorified harmonizes Luke 24, John 20, and 1 Corinthians 15:44 to 54 without preloading the outcome.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.15.4
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.15.44
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Luke.24.39
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.20.27
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.2.21

morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Acts.2.31
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1Cor.15.44
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1Cor.15.45
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1453
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4561
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4983
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5589
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4152
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Acts.2.31
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Cor.15.4
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Luke.24.39
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Cor.15.4
variant	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	Mark.16.9-20
variant	Nestle1904-text	public_domain	yes	Luke.24.40

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